

Question:

A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?

Answer Choices:

- A. Behavior therapy
- B. Methimazole
- C. Fluoxetine
- D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:

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Finding reasoning paths :

- 1 . Conductive hearing loss -> Unable to focus -> Disruptive behavior
- 2 . Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) -> Unable to focus -> Disruptive behavior
- 3 . Conductive hearing loss -> Interruptive behavior -> Disruptive behavior

Reasoning Process :

- 1 . **Conductive Hearing Loss and Attention Issues**: The child's inability to listen and concentrate , as well as his interruptive and disruptive behavior , could potentially be related to a conductive hearing loss . Conductive hearing loss can cause difficulty in hearing and understanding speech , which may lead to frustration and behavioral issues such as interrupting others . This could explain his inability to focus and his disruptive behavior .
- 2 . **Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD)**: The child's inability to concentrate and his behavior of interrupting others could also suggest ADHD . ADHD is characterized by inattention , hyperactivity , and impulsivity , which align with the child's symptoms . However , it is important to rule out other causes before diagnosing ADHD .
- 3 . **Evaluation and Treatment**: Given the child's symptoms , it would be prudent to evaluate both conductive hearing loss and ADHD . An audiometric test can help determine if the hearing loss is conductive and is of sufficient severity to cause the observed symptoms . If conductive hearing loss is confirmed , appropriate hearing aids can be prescribed . If ADHD is diagnosed , behavioral therapy and possibly medication like methylphenidate could be considered . However , given the lack of specific mention of hyperactivity or impulsivity , ADHD is less likely to be the primary issue .

Conclusion :

The most appropriate next step in treatment depends on the evaluation results . If conductive hearing loss is confirmed , providing hearing aids would address the primary issue . If ADHD is the diagnosis , further behavioral and medical interventions would be necessary . Therefore , hearing aids could be a part of the treatment plan if the hearing loss is indeed contributing to the child's symptoms .

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Hearing aids

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